

OREGON CITY COURIER

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THE TAX LIST

If Samuel Jackson, Esq., publisher of the Oregon Journal of Portland, will take the blinders of willful maliciousness from eyes that will see not and guards from ears that will hear not, he will discover that he is undoubtedly on the wrong track regarding the publication of the delinquent tax list.

Although Mr. Jackson is just now in the midst of a very frantic fight against the country press, in which the monster is fighting for the bread in the mouth of the babe, we have not seen him in his gracious magnanimity refusing to take the spoils for the publication of the Multnomah county delinquent tax list. He has not wrapped himself in a mantle of holy purity and refused to take his share.

In the counties outside Multnomah there is no "share." What the Courier and other papers earn from the publication of the delinquent tax list each year is paid to us for service rendered.

There is no attempt to rob the county in the publication of these lists anywhere in the state unless it be by the Oregon Journal, which the upright and honorable Sam Jackson publishes in Portland. What the Courier and other papers charge the county is a legitimate advertising rate and in many cases is not as much as the work involved is worth.

In Clackamas county, for instance, how inefficient would the notification by mail of delinquent taxpayers be. In the name of efficiency, if for no other of a dozen reasons, the delinquent tax list more nearly fills its purpose when published in the two papers of greatest circulation than it would if published in any other way.

In some counties, no doubt, evil newspapers have made a "graff" of the publication of the lists. What is needed, then, is a law that will regulate the thing rather than abolish it. The post card service would be a mockery and it is an absolute fact that the extra help required to mail out statements to delinquent taxpayers, listing the property and addressing the cards, would COST MORE than to publish the lists in the newspapers.

If economy is Sam Jackson's motto in his fight against the country papers he has evidently forgotten the meaning of the word. If efficiency is his guide he doesn't know the first principle of its practice.

COPPERHEAD

The nation's millions breathing the fearful odor of impending war; its president and its congress spending day and night planning a defense of the honor of a flag; men, women and children, natives and aliens, a united mass of people praying that blood may not be shed, yet pledging themselves to fight to the death for the stars and stripes.

That is the position of President Woodrow Wilson's government today. He stands at the helm of the ship in whose cabin he has been a worthy guide for four years, steering the bark of reason and justice into channels that flow with heroic efforts to do the right thing, to save the multitudes from the terror of war, to protect the fathers, the mothers and the sons of a great nation from the bullets of an enemy. For numberless years a war might continue, with the life blood of the United States shacking the thirst of foreign guns, before Old Glory could again wave her starry field over a peaceful and prosperous nation.

And in the midst of this touching spectacle of heroism and sound judgment—whose reason directs that our boys may be kept from the trenches, that every nation under the sun may be as brothers in progress with us—the Morning Enterprise, wallowing in

the mire of its ignorance, flaunts from its window the banner of freedom and shouts patriotism from the house top. It copies news stories from the Oregonian to make its readers believe it actually knows that Woodrow Wilson and his government have exercised every power of human forbearance in warding off the first blow of war. And on an inside page, side by side with a lot of crude editorial matter, this morning mesozoic gives space for the publication of a verse labeled "He Kept Us Out of War," whose very author is so ashamed of his words that he signs a pen name. The evil concoction of misplaced rhyme and meter was sent to the "mourning" Enterprise by the republican publicity committee or other agency, and the paper, childlike, takes the candy with a gracious display of type and ignorance.

Meanwhile the flag for which our fathers' blood was shed, the flag whose honor is the guide of every official act of the government of the United States, now and always before regardless of presidential politics, waves sadly from the front window of the "mourning" Enterprise.

LESS BUSHEL—MORE MONEY

The government bureau of crop estimates, issued recently, comparing 1916 crop yields and values under existing prices with yields and prices for the same crops on the same dates in 1915, affords the basis for an impressive exhibit for several of the staple crops listed. A little figuring shows that, although there was a decrease of 400 million bushels of wheat in 1916, the total selling value of the crop was \$18,000,000 greater than the larger crop in 1915; notwithstanding the decrease of 400 million bushels in the corn crop, it had a value of \$350,000,000 above last year's crop; the oats crop was 300 million bushels less than in 1916, but it had a value of \$60,000,000 above the crop of 1915; similarly there was a reduction of 70,000,000 bushels in the 1916 potato crop, but the smaller production had a value of \$175,000,000 more than the larger crop of last year.

From this computation it may be seen that notwithstanding there was a total decrease of over a billion bushels in the aggregate yield of these four staple crops in 1916, the higher prices obtaining gave them a market value of over \$500,000,000 more than the larger yields of the previous year at the same date. But if the higher market prices current a short time after the government report was issued is taken as a basis of reckoning, the overplus of value would have had a market value of a billion dollars more than last year, when their combined yield was a billion bushels greater than the 1916 harvest.

Considered from another angle, how much of this billion-dollar increase in value since these crops were harvested did the producers receive as a reward for their skill and labor? Had this billion-dollar increase in the value of these four staple farm crops been realized by our six million farm owners their average share of this advance in value would have been \$150 a farm. But those actually engaged in growing these crops in a commercial way would have had an addition to their incomes ranging from \$500 to \$1,000, or more.

The lesson in these figures is the need of better farm storage with which to take advantage of advancing crop values. When distributors are keen to get crops even before they are harvested, the farmer should be in a position to store his crops and secure at least a fair share of any advance that market conditions promise. —Farm and Fireside.

SOCIALIST LOSSES

The last presidential election

showed once more that socialism in the United States isn't much more than a general protest against existing conditions—that it lacks the constructive force of the socialistic movement in European countries. The socialist vote, which had been increasing the three or four preceding elections, fell off markedly. It was only about two-thirds of the vote of 1912.

As a party of protest the socialist party is performing a useful service, says the Dallas Chronicle. It helps to keep our social and economic thought stirred up and active. "It serves to feed into the American mind all sorts of new ideas imported from less conservative lands. It calls vigorous attention to stand-pattisms and miscellaneous stupidities and injustices in our social and political system. It is a sort of gad-fly to the big parties. It drives them forward along new lines of social and economic reform."

The low socialist vote in the 1916 election is thus really a token of success. It is because the big parties have absorbed so many "socialistic" ideas that they have absorbed so large a part of the old socialist vote, and have held hundreds of thousands of citizens who otherwise would have gone over to the socialist party.

Thus the American socialists correspond rather roughly to the Fabian socialists of England, who under the leadership of Bernard Shaw and other far-sighted thinkers have succeeded in getting a large part of their legislative programme enacted without putting themselves forward prominently. It's a question of subordinating party to principles. The American socialists perhaps are not conscious of doing this. Most of the leaders, in fact, seem more concerned with holding the party organization together than with making their propaganda succeed. But the practical result is that, no matter what happens to their organization, such useful and constructive ideas as they put forward are picked up and carried forward by the older, more conservative parties, as fast as the public can assimilate them.

IT'S BENEFIT PROVED

Results are proof positive on any question which may be submitted for trial. Results are what we require when we launch a matter of general interest to the public, and when those results are demonstrated as plainly and forcibly as have been done by prohibition in this and our sister state on the north, it only seems logical that the scales should fall from the eyes of the doubting Thomases and their voices should be hushed from shame. Yet, in the face of facts and figures some persist in keeping their eyes shut and in trying to convince others that it is an optical illusion. Well, it is to their financial interest, so I suppose they cannot be blamed for their efforts—if we reduce humanity to dollars and cents—but those who are interested in humanity, progress and civic betterment should study the great advance in prosperity, the increased bank deposits, the wonderful decrease in poverty, misery and crime—the health, wealth and happiness of the present as against the misery, poverty and sorrow which filled these states a little more than a year ago.

Few business men who are in decent and legitimate lines of trade will tell you that their affairs are not more prosperous under prohibition; no officer of the law will deny that crime has decreased from 20 to 60 per cent in his community since the saloon was voted out; physicians and heads of state institutions are unanimous in the statement that insanity cases are far more scarce and that the general health of the people is much better than when the state was "wet."

In the face of these unassailable facts can any one still refuse to admit that prohibition is a good thing?—Lend A Hand.

PARTY AND STATE DEAD

Meredith Says Socialists Want Democratic, not Aristocratic Rule

The socialists of Clackamas county look to the Courier as their "official organ" with a persistency worthy of results. I address the socialists of this county under authority granted me.

The socialist party as a political party is dead. I wish to add in connection that the democratic and republican parties are also dead. I wish to state that there is no further use for these parties on account of the demise of the state. Government is not dead, but more alive than ever. All government now comes from corporations and not from a dead state and is not formulated by dead political parties but is formed and executed by business.

Our state has granted all its powers, and more, too, to corporations as its last will and testament, and its remains lie enshrouded in the temple of aristocracy. While the socialists have wasted their substance in an attempt to get possession of the carcass of state the corporations have taken possession of the industrial government socialists have so long wished for. Aristocracy still rules, however, and the long-sought revolution is on, and no political party or combination of parties can stop it. All laws against trusts are dead because the power of the state is dead. Republicans vote the democratic ticket and so do socialists. Democrats vote for republicans and such a thing as party does not now exist. Socialists must get this truth well learned before they can go out in the world and do things for humanity.

What we socialists want now is democracy to rule business instead of aristocracy. We socialists have been the greatest factor in starting the earth on its gigantic revolution for the Brotherhood of Humanity. We now can congratulate ourselves and buckle on an improved armor for the completion of our mission. We must not waste our energy in trying to get

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The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad guage life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this pity was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

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The Mitchell Water System supplies you with unlimited dependable supply of pure cool water at no more cost (usually not as much) per month than is paid by the average city man for his restricted supply. This is not so of other water systems, which often are a source of a great deal more trouble than satisfaction owing to improper construction or poor installation. We have installed hundreds of Mitchell Systems in all parts of the Northwest—they are giving satisfaction to every buyer. We, if given the opportunity, will gladly give you the benefit of our 15 years' experience in the pneumatic water supply line. We will plan for your home a Mitchell System that will exactly fit your requirements—that will give you service which will please you now and continue to do so for years and years—that's our policy—COMPLETE AND PERMANENT SATISFACTION TO EVERY BUYER—and we have the goods that uphold every claim we make for them. Write us today for our free book on country and suburban water supply systems. Ask for book.

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OREGON CITY, OREGON

HOG PRICES HIGH

Market For Week Shows Favorable Increase. Record Prices

Compared with last week and a year ago the arrival of cattle for the first day of this week is showing a large increase. There was a total of 1350 head on the Portland market. The market opened very active, killed at liberal orders and the run was disposed of quickly at steady to 10 cents higher. The quality of the beef offerings was the best seen for some time and was just what killers wanted.

Prices on beef steers were all on a steady to as much as 20 cents higher basis and all offerings crossed the scales early. The top for the day was 20 cents above last week's. One load of prime lights brought \$9.20 with another load at \$9.15. Several bunches of light hay-feds also got in at \$9. There was a liberal spread of good kinds which found a ready outlet at prices ranging from \$8.50 to \$8.80. Medium steers brought \$8 to \$8.25, with several loads of good quality feeding steers at \$7.50 and \$7.60.

There was a light supply of cows in the day's trade, which were on the fair to good order. A number of small lots brought \$7.50 with several loads of fairly good cows at \$7 to \$7.10. Ordinary beef cows brought around \$6.50 with a few common ones at \$5.25 and \$5.50. One prime heifer brought \$8 and a bunch sold at \$7.75. There was a good demand for the light supply of bulls at steady prices. A few prime heavy bulls brought \$6 from packers with a number of good bulls at \$5.75; medium at \$5.

All record prices for hogs were broken Monday when another 25 to 30 cents advance was made. Several loads of prime heavy porkers brought \$11.75. Receipts for the day were only moderate, quality was on the mixed order, although the bulk of arrivals was very good. California contributed about 800 head which included a good many light hogs. The prime heavy hogs were the best sellers, bringing an advance of 35 cents over last week's top, while good packing hogs sold from \$11.50 to \$11.60, bulk of sales were made from \$11.45 to \$11.50. Pigs met a very good call and brought another 25 cents advance. A few lots sold up to \$11, but the bulk went at \$10.25.

A Woman's Experience With Grippe

When a cough or cold "hangs in," and you have aches and pains in your joints and muscles, it is likely that grippe is taking hold of your system. Mrs. J. A. Rodgers, Switzer, Conn., says: "I am susceptible to colds, often ending in grippe. In this case I have found Foley's Honey and Tar to prevent doctor bills." This sterling family remedy loosens the phlegm, stops irritation, allays soreness and inflammation and frees the air passages. Good for children.—Jones Drug Co.

COMPANY IS STRONG

Many Oregon City Boys Still in Captain Blanchard's Command

In case the national guard of the state is again called into service through any unforeseen emergency arising out of the present international crisis with Germany, Company G, Oregon National Guard, commanded by Captain Lowell E. Blanchard of this city and now stationed at

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VIKING

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Come in and look at it and see for yourself why it is the biggest Cream Separator value on the market.

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You have only a short time to take advantage of our magazine offer.

Blossom Time in the Golden State

A friend just back from Southern California says: "The weather was fine, in fact to warm for heavy clothes. Many were bathing at the beaches. Oranges were ripe in the valleys, while the mountains nearby were covered with snow."

With warm sunny weather it will not be long before the blossoms on the trees will be everywhere announcing that springtime is here.

Take a vacation trip now where life is different; where climate surroundings and amusements are out of the ordinary. Spend a different February.

Three Trains Daily

Scenic Shasta Route

will take you there in comfort
Ask the Agent

JOHN M. SCOTT, General Passenger Agent, Portland

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Courtesy Our Specialty

Every man, woman and child who has dealings with us, is treated with courtesy.

You are made to feel welcome—because you are welcome.

Which is all we are going to say to you to-day—but after all doesn't courteous treatment go a ways with you? It does with us.

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